

SURREY SCOUT

NOVEMBER, 1978

No. 378

County Commissioner

Next year, Scouting will be slightly less expensive. The Committee of the Council, having reviewed the finances of Headquarters in the light of ever-increasing costs, has decided that the Membership Subscription payable on 1st April 1979 will be £1.75 for each member. The County Executive Committee, after considering the County's budget for next year, has reluctantly decided that the time has also come for the County contribution to be increased. For two years, this has stood at 25p plus 5p per member for the Development and International Fund. On the 1st April 1979 this will be increased to 30p and 5p respectively.

Together therefore, the Membership fee and County contribution will amount to £2.10 to which most Districts will need to add their own levy. The increased amounts will be payable by all members on the census on 31st March 1979, other than those specifically exempted.

Despite these increases Scouting will still represent unequalled value for money. What other organisation offer such a wide range of worthwhile activities for such a small annual outlay? There is plenty of time in the coming months to work out how the extra cost is going to be met, e.g. by fund raising activities and/or increased subscriptions. Nevertheless, we do need to take heed that our programmes are exciting and adventurous. If they are our membership will go on rising steadily - whatever the cost!

Scouting has a job to do. At the National Commissioners Conference at Loughborough University in September, the Chief Scout drew attention to the declining population and the likelihood of a drop in Cub Scout membership in the 1980s unless we attract a higher percentage of the eligible age range. To get quantity, we have to offer quality. Successful Groups always attract members but a special effort will need to be made at District level to support those which are less successful.

Society, as the Chief pointed out, is becoming more and more in need of what Scouting can offer.

With the sad increase in the number of broken homes, the family of Scouting can provide security and fellowship. It also provides training in a wide range of activities and encourages service to others, self discipline, learning to make successful use of increased leisure time and developing the ability to stand on one's own feet.

We have a unique opportunity in Scouting to help develop the citizen of tomorrow. Scouting is service. Scoutreach opportunities lie at our own doorsteps.

After ten years as District Commissioner for Haslemere, Col. Jack Hilder has decided to take a less active role in the District. He has exchanged appointments with John Bunker, A.D.C. (General). John was a warrant holder in Essex for twelve years before moving to Haslemere where, for the past ten years, he has been an A.D.C. We wish him every success as he takes up his new appointment from 1st November.

Jack Hilder will continue to be actively involved in the Explorer Belt Scheme which I greatly commend to all adventurous-minded Venture Scouts. Details are published in "Scouting" from time to time and can also be obtained from John Havers, A.C.C. (International).

Finally, it is a great pleasure to note that Surrey County Council has appointed Geoffrey Hepworth as the County Youth and Community Adviser. We have always enjoyed active support from County Hall and this appointment will undoubtedly strengthen the link. Geoffrey was District Commissioner for Guildford from 1967 to 1973 and has always maintained a close interest in Scouting. We wish him every success in this new and demanding appointment.

GORDON BATES

Cub Scouts

The County Cub Scout Sub-committee met in September and considered three main items, details of which will be of general concern to Leaders as follows :-

NEW COUNTY CUB SCOUT PRAYER CARD

Father Barry Anderson introduced his ideas for an exciting new County Cub Scout Prayer Card which is now needed because supplies of the existing card have been exhausted. The proposed new card which was approved by the meeting will hopefully be available early in the new year and this time will be illustrated in pictures. The prayers used will relate directly to the four training areas for Cub Scouts - Growing up, Discovering, Sharing and Thinking; thus forming a 'bridge' between the activities experienced by the Cub Scout and prayer. The prayers on the card have deliberately been left incomplete leaving the Cub Scout to develop his own prayers and to assist Leaders in their training. Father Anderson is preparing support material for issue with the cards to give ideas to Leaders, suggestions for Scouts' Own, help in getting Cub Scouts to pray, and a list of books currently available which may be helpful.

I am pleased to confirm that at a subsequent meeting of the County Executive, it was agreed that the cost of the card would be met from County Sectional funds and the new card, like the previous one, will therefore be issued without charge and I hope will be widely used by Leaders throughout the County.

DEVELOPED ARROW SCHEME

Here we had a very wide ranging discussion and it was apparent that many Assistant District Commissioners were reporting that the Scheme continues to cause problems throughout the County. At the time of our meeting the October issue of "Scouting" was not available but I would draw Leader's attention to the letter on Page 717 of October "Scouting" entitled 'One Year On' from Ian Roy, A.D.C. (Cub Scouts) South Angus, which sums up admirably the views expressed by many at our meeting.

The views of the County have been made known to the National Cub Scout Board and a copy of my

letter to the Board Representative is being distributed to A.D.C.s with this issue of "Surrey Scout" and I would ask that this be considered at your next District Meeting to ensure that the views expressed by the County Sub-Committee do really reflect the views of all Leaders working within Packs. If we are to bring about change, we must be constructive in our suggestions and our thoughts must be made known.

CUB COUNTRY

The meeting considered "Cub Country", full details of which were published in last month's "Surrey Scout" and agreed to give wholehearted support to this worthwhile venture. I hope that throughout 1979, we will be reading in the "Surrey Scout" imaginative reports of "Cub Country" events that are taking place around the County and a working party has been set up to see how "Cub Country" can feature in our proposed County event in May 1979.

A.D.C.s Training Weekend

It was with considerable regret that we had to cancel this weekend due to lack of support. I was particularly concerned to find at our County Meeting that some A.D.C.s had not received the literature that was circulated with last month's "Surrey Scout" and I am assured that this was distributed to all Districts from the County end and it would therefore seem that there is a distribution problem within some Districts. I would ask that any A.D.C. concerned who did not receive these papers, should take this up within the District to see what has gone wrong.

Personal

Due to increasing commitments I have had to request the County Commissioner to relieve me of the duties of A.C.C. (Cub Scouts) from the end of this year. Having been A.C.C. for seven years, I think that the time is now right for a new Leader of the Cub Scout section and hopefully by next month's issue of "Surrey Scout", we will be in a position to announce the name of my successor. In the meantime, can I thank all who have worked with me for their considerable support over the past seven years.

DEREK BASSETT

Leader Training

Set out below are dates of a number of General Information courses which have been arranged by Districts during the next few months. If you should be attending one of this type of course as the first stage of your training as a Leader ask your A.D.C. (L.T.) when the next course will be held in your District. If there is none in the near future then contact the person named below in the District nearest to you, there is often a value to be gained from taking a course with Leaders from another District.

The same applies to Basic courses. Further details of those fixed by the County training team in some Districts are set out below. As soon as it has been possible to establish with the host Districts the final venues of the others mentioned the details will be published. In the meantime if any of them are of interest to you contact the named Leader who will ensure that a place is held and details sent to you. The names and addresses of all members of the County team are shown in the County Directory.

Following the completion of Leader training courses at Gilwell Park and involvement in a wide range of County sources as members of the staff I am pleased to report that Howard Smith, A.D.C. (Gen.) of South and Upper Norwood and Frank Kitchener lately A.D.C. (L.T.) for Walton and Weybridge and currently a Cub Scout Leader have accepted invitations to become Assistant Leader Trainers. They will make important contributions to Leader training in the areas in which they live as well as play a more prominent part in future County courses.

From time to time I hear that Venture Scout Leaders wonder whether they can take the Ranger Guide Leaders Camper Licence. This is of particular value to Leaders who are involved with joint or mixed units. Any Leader who would like to attend the small course which is to be offered in the Guide County of Surrey East is invited to contact Mrs. D.M. Davis, Burngill, Tadworth Street, Surrey. The dates are November 20th & 27th (evenings) and 11th/13th May 1979.

DAVID R. BARRELL

Courses

General Information Courses

Staines	25th and 26th November
Twickenham	4th and 11th December
Surbiton	14th January
Epsom	4th February

P. Hill, 26 Everest Road, Stanwell, Staines.
R. Browne, 48 Avondale Road, Ashford.
D. Whiteman, 38 Effingham Road, Long Ditton.
H. Laing, 45 Meadowview Road, West Ewell.

Basic Courses

CUB SCOUT LEADERS

Sutton	25th/26th November
Reigate	20th/21st January
Kingston	January
Godalming	24th February and 10th March
Epsom/Ewell	25th/26th February
Croydon	March
Woking	April

Miss M. Pooley, 71 Beech Grove, Mitcham.
R. Penfold, 49 Wolverton Gardens, Horley.
S. Street, 15 Summerville Gardens, Cheam.

Mrs. W. Viner, 58 West Bank, Dorking.

D. Brown, 21 Langsmead, Blindley Heath.
Mrs. M. Walden, 31 Langton Way, Croydon.
F. Fentiman, "Woodside", Meadow Way, Gt. Bookham

SCOUT LEADERS

Croydon	25th/26th November
Godalming	27th January

J.M. Elliot, 22 Parkway, Ratton Manor, Eastbourne, Sussex.

J.M. Elliot, 22 Parkway, Ratton Manor, Eastbourne, Sussex.

D. Barker, 3 Oriental Close, Woking.

Kingston 24th/25th February

VENTURE SCOUT LEADERS

Bentley Copse 17th/18th March

B.C. Wood, 36 Sole Farm Road, Gt. Bookham.

GROUP SCOUT LEADERS

Sutton 17th/18th February

E.J. Walden, 31 Langton Way, Croydon.

Advanced Courses

CUB SCOUT LEADERS

Morden 12th/19th November &
(non-residential) 3rd/10th December

E.W. Daniel, 7 Barfield Court, Ladbroke Road, Redhill

VENTURE SCOUT LEADERS

Chalfont St.Giles 3rd/5th November &
(G.L.N.W.Course) 10th/12th November

M.A. Coombe, 203 Tentelow Lane, Norwood Green, Southall, Middx.

Scouts

Good weather marked the week-end of the County Patrol and Camping Competition held at Walton Firs, and because of this the depth of experience of the competing Patrols was not put to the ultimate test that can apply when bad weather prevails! However, that is in no way a criticism of what turned out to be a keenly contested competition when 33 Patrols representing 17 of our Districts showed their abilities. The standard was very high, and all Patrols who took part are to be congratulated.

The judging team of four Venture Scouts from Surrey worked extremely hard and well during the week-end, and I should like to express my appreciation and thanks to them again for a job well done. My thanks also go to Woking District who organised the activities and all the background domestic arrangements. It was good to see such an enthusiastic and efficient team of Woking Scout Fellowship members playing such an important part in the organisation.

As I mentioned earlier, competition was keen and the final results reflected the closeness of a very high standard of camping and activity. The top six placings were as follows:

- 1st : Beaver Patrol of 1st New Haw, representing Runnymede District, P.L.T. Kent, scoring 312.
- 2nd : Peewit Patrol of 7th Reigate, scoring 298.
- 3rd : Panther Patrol of 4th Ewell, scoring 296.
- 4th : Buffalo Patrol of 7th Reigate, scoring 294

5th : Falcon Patrol of 1st West Byfleet, scoring 292.

6th : Wolf Patrol of 1st New Haw, scoring 291.

During the week-end, as I walked around the site it was easy to spot the Patrols which were well organised, with good communication and co-operation amongst the Patrol members. Much thoughtful planning had obviously gone into the preparations, and I would like to think that this is the way all Patrols in the County would approach their camps and activities. In thanking the Leaders for all the help and guidance they gave their Patrol Leaders I would go on to ask that this should be the regular week by week process, and not just applied when a competition is in the offing! In speaking to the Scouts it was obvious that they enjoyed working out the details of activities, menus, equipment lists, costings, duty rotas, etc. It just proved yet again that given a chance, and with the right sort of adult guidance, our Patrol Leaders and Patrols of today are every bit as capable and efficient as at any time during the life of our Movement. I was impressed by the air of maturity that came through from many of the Patrol Leaders, and it was obvious that many Troops in our County are making an excellent job in training their boys for ultimate responsibility and citizenship. P.O.R. Rule 1 was to me being helped along quite well during that week-end at Walton Firs!

JIM ELLIOT

Finance

Elsewhere in this issue of "Surrey Scout", the County Commissioner has referred to the increased costs of Headquarters Subscription and County Contribution due on 1st April next year; no doubt Districts too, will have to look hard at their figures and perhaps increase their levies as well.

It is small comfort to a struggling Group to be told that the cost is still less than half of a daily newspaper per week when faced with the problem of finding £2 odd times the number of boys and Leaders in the Group on 1st April next.

It's all very well to be told that Scouting is inexpensive, when you look at the Group Bank Statement on 29th March.

So what to do about it?

Firstly, and most sensibly, what about the subscriptions the boys are paying. Boys (and parents, too) equate the worth of something by its price. Is your Troop Meeting worth a bag of crisps? Does it cost your Scouts more to get to the meeting than the meeting itself? Subscriptions vary wildly from Group to Group even in the same District. Would it be sensible to check up on what other Groups are

charging?

Secondly, is your Fund Raising worthwhile? After hours of collecting, sorting, setting up and clearing away, does your Jumble Sale only produce £20? A well organised event will bring more money, more goodwill and more satisfaction. You will be better off to aim at £100 and get 50% than aim at £30 and get 100%.

Thirdly, are there some methods of Fund raising you haven't tried yet? We hear of many bright ideas but we don't always hear how well (or badly) these bright ideas go. And this is where YOU can help YOU. We would like to publish in "Surrey Scout" various methods of Fund Raising - new ones and old ones. The flops as well as the successes.

Fourthly, Scout Headquarters has a very useful "Fund Raising Pack" which is full of ideas, certainly worth looking at.

Lastly, but by no means least, if your Group is small; why not a joint project with one or more other Groups?

DOUG. BENNETT

Scout Fellowship

Euroscout Camping Competition

This most successful event at Perry Wood National Campsite, was organised and staffed by members of Scout Fellowships throughout Surrey and was enjoyed by boys and adults alike.

Activities varied from Backwoods Cooking, Mediaeval Games, and Absailing to an almost too real motor cycle accident. A highly enjoyable Camp Fire made it a memorable weekend.

Not least among the benefits was the social contact of Fellowship members from all over the County. Jack Yerrell the Warden, has written expressing his sincere thanks and asking us to undertake the 1979 competition. Sadly, there were very few competitors from Surrey; perhaps we may see more of our Scouts there next year.

Recruitment

Amongst the many ideas for recruitment is an interesting one from Reigate. Dennis Kent has contacted former officials and warrant holders in the District inviting them to join the Fellowship. If you are interested in this method of recruitment, please contact Dennis for details.

Any other schemes in operation? An exchange of ideas would benefit all.

International

We will be discussing aspects of the International Fellowship at the next meeting of the County Sub-Committee but in the meantime, details are available of the 13th General Assembly of the International Fellowship in Bergen, Norway from 8th to 15th August 1979. Accommodation is in a students' hostel, cost £120 per person. The varied programme includes excursions and home hospitality as guests of

members of the Guild of St. George in Norway. There is also available, at extra cost, a 3-day tour of Norway from 11th to 13th August. Full details from me, or Scout Headquarters, Baden-Powell House.

Service

Some Fellowships complain that their Districts still don't use them to the full or even at all at District events etc. Whilst accepting that old habits die hard and that in some areas the unenlightened still distrust this "new" section of the Movement, we must ask ourselves in all honesty if we have kept everyone informed that the Fellowship is in existence, what we can undertake, what resources we have available,

Nobody buys in a shop if he doesn't know what the shop has to sell. Let us ensure that our shop is attractively and informatively set up in the market place of Scouting - keep in close contact with sections and A.D.C.s, identify needs and help to meet them; that's our job.

Odds and Ends

Disappointing to note that Surrey was not represented at the National Fellowship Camp this past summer.

Your comments on Fellowship scarves have been passed onto the appropriate authorities for action (?).

Is your District involved in 'Tune-a-Radio' Week? Can you help? (See "Scouting" September issue).

Ron Jefferies, editor of "Scouting" magazine would be interested to hear of any unusual or special events in which Fellowship members are involved with photographs for the 'Newscast' feature.

The next meeting of the County Sub-Committee will be held on November 8th at 7.45 p.m. in West Ewell. Please see that your District is represented.

ERIC MACKIE

County Chaplain

Quite apart from my Scouting activities I was having to think the other day about being prepared for things. Our familiar motto thought about in an unusual context prompted some new ideas which may be useful in Scouts Own or the like.

BE PREPARED as a motto sometimes seems to demand courage and foresight which we lack. But lots of preparations can be enjoyable. Think of the way we get ready for a party or a holiday. And preparing for an exam - although a bind when we have to do it - brings the rewards we need.

And in less specific ways, the attitude to life we

adopt can make us ready to get the best out of the good things which happen or ensure that the bad ones don't defeat us.

But we also have to admit that we can't prepare for everything. And that's where we need something inside to equip us for the unexpected when it crops up. At the vital moment - whether it's a happy or sad one - it will be too late to get ready.

It's the love and faith of today which prepares us for the uncertainties of tomorrow. And that love and faith provides the courage and foresight which we don't have at the moment.

MICHAEL MEECH

Congratulations

Rifle Club

DUKE OF EDINBURGH'S GOLD AWARD

Paul Daniell, Instructor, 1st Whyteleafe

LONG SERVICE DECORATION

Anthony J.M. Hamer V.S.L. 1st Godstone
 Frederick R. Hughes A.D.C.(V.S.) East Surrey
 Extension Adviser East Surrey & Horley
 John W.O. Harwood A.D.C.(Gen.) Horley

County Diary

November

8 Scout Fellowship Sub-Committee West Ewell
 25 County Symposium Reigate

December

5 Water Activities Committee Cuddington
 7 Venture Scout Sub-Committee Dorking

1979

January

8 Scout Sub-Committee Leatherhead
 31 Cub Scout Sub-Committee Leatherhead

February

17 Chief Scout's Award Presentation Reigate
 25 Scout First Aid Competition East Surrey

April

2 Scout Sub-Committee Leatherhead
 5 Cub Scout Sub-Committee Leatherhead

June

9 Chief Scout's Award Presentation Sunbury

July

2 Scout Sub-Committee
 13/15 Scoutout '79 Rushmoor Arena

September

29/30 Scout Patrol & Camping Competition Bentley Copse

October

4 Cub Scout Sub-Committee Leatherhead

December "Surrey Scout"

Copy Date Saturday 11th November
 Distribution Sunday 26th November

Twenty three teams from sixteen Venture Scout Units competed at the Club's Annual Shoot at Bisley on 15th October last, making it the largest entry in the history of this event. There was a considerable increase in the number of ladies competing for the Ladies Plate and the high scores of some of them put many of the male Venture Scouts to shame! Trophies and medals were presented to the winners by the Club's Vice-President, Jack Day at the end of a well organised day for which the Secretary, Terry Harrison, was responsible.

Winners were:

President's Cup for highest morning score Ian Pettett, 2nd Westborough
 Donegal Badge for highest afternoon score Ian Pettett, 2nd Westborough (45 points)
 Ladies Plate for highest score by a female Venture Scout or Ranger Ruth Fowler, 1st Ripley (37 points)
 County Full Bore Shield, highest team score. Woolpack V.S.U. 142 points
 2nd 2nd Westborough "A" 131 points
 3rd Old Woking 123 points
 4th 3rd Ashford "A" 116 points
 5th Dorking Four Hills "A" 112 points
 5th Staines 112 points
 1st Fetcham 108 points
 2nd Westborough "B" 99 points
 9th 1st West Byfleet "A" 97 points
 10th 4th Walton-on-Thames 96 points

Major-General E.H. Goulburn D.S.O., D.L., was unable to be present due to another engagement but as in previous years, provided medals for the individual members of the first three teams.

One small P.S. a "Parker 51" ball-point pen was found on the firing area at the end of the day, will the owner please claim from Doug. Bennett (Dorking 87292).